

Sunday Menu — Reverse-Seared Bone-In Rack Chops

Three covers. Service window 6:37–7:02 pm. Governance framework v3.5.

The Menu

- Reverse-seared bone-in rack chops, mustard-thyme sauce
- Braised red cabbage with apple and juniper (made Saturday)
- Crushed potatoes in pork, duck or olive fat
- Charred tenderstem broccoli with lemon (chilli served separately)
- Crackling shards — conditional, only if the rind arrives with the rack

Crackling Dependency — Read Before Shopping

If the rack is skin-on and the counter can give you the rind as an intact sheet of roughly 250 g or more, render it, use the fat for the potatoes, and serve the shards.

If not — rind already removed, irregular, or under about 200 g — omit crackling entirely and use 40 g duck fat or olive oil for the potatoes. Do not buy a rind separately to force the component, and do not ask the counter to preserve one. The plate is already rich; crackling is a bonus, not a load-bearing element.

Meal Workflow

Critical Path

Chop oven exit → 8 min rest → temperature-gated sear → 7 min rest → carve. A fixed 22-minute convergence sequence with no compressible steps.

Strategy: fixed convergence, floating service. The low-roast band is genuinely 55–80 minutes from fridge-cold and cannot be reliably steered. Rather than absorb that variance in a hold window — which fails, because a long pre-sear rest leaves the sear too much ground to make up — the variance goes into service time. Everything from the oven exit onward is measured in minutes after exit, written E+. Set a timer at the exit and stop watching the clock.

Failure Prioritization

Protect the chops' internal temperature above everything. It is the only unrecoverable failure on the table, and dryness is the specific concern this menu was built around.

- If the sear runs long, serve the potatoes and broccoli cooler. Do not shorten the post-sear rest.
- If the potatoes are not crisp at E+19, plate them as they are.
- If the chops have not reached 133°F / 56°C, wait. Service moves; the chops do not.
- If everything converges late, serve the cabbage lukewarm. It is the most heat-tolerant component.

Oven Sequencing

225°F / 107°C, constant, chops only. No mid-cook temperature change — a downward steer actuates through the Bosch's slow transition and the effect lags unpredictably. At exit, drop to 170°F / 77°C, crack the door two minutes to speed the drop, and put the plates in. Nothing else competes for the oven at any point.

Heat Resource Allocation

Resource	Component	Window
Induction 1	Rind rendering (conditional)	2:20–3:20 pm
Induction 1	Sauce base pre-reduction	5:30–5:45 pm
Induction 1	Sauce finish (sear pan carried in)	E+12 → E+18
Induction 2	Cabbage reheat	E+2 → E+17
Oven	Chop low-roast, then plate warming	5:20 pm → service
Outdoor gas 1	Potatoes crisping	E–5 → E+19
Outdoor gas 2	Broccoli charring	E+10 → E+17
Outdoor gas 3	Chop sear	E+8 → E+12

Burner-count validation: peak concurrency at E+10 — outdoor gas 1, 2 and 3 plus induction 2. Four of five available burners. Closes with one spare. The sear is outdoors deliberately; it smokes heavily and belongs away from indoor extraction. Both chops fit one cast-iron pan at 300–400 g each without collapsing the surface temperature.

Parallel vs. Sequential

Parallel: potatoes, cabbage, broccoli and the sear all run inside the E+ window.

Sequential, non-overlappable: exit → rest → sear → rest → carve.

Cannot overlap: the sauce finish requires the sear fond, so it cannot begin before the sear ends. The post-sear rest is not idle time — it is the sauce window.

Timeline Verification

Forward: salt 2:15 pm → 3 hr 5 min brine → oven 5:20 pm → 55–80 min → exit 6:15–6:40 pm → 22 min convergence → service 6:37–7:02 pm.

Band closure: the 25-minute low-roast band lands entirely in service time. The convergence sequence is a fixed 22 minutes at both ends of the band, so no hold ceiling is stressed and no corrective is required. Earliest and latest finishes produce identical sequences, 25 minutes apart. Holds at plating: potatoes 1 min, broccoli 3 min, cabbage 3 min, sauce 4 min — all well inside their ceilings.

This is a deliberate deviation from pure T-minus format, taken because a fixed-service timeline cannot close against this band without violating a hold ceiling. The absolute-time phase is stated in clock time; the convergence is exit-relative.

Chop Divergence Rule

E+0 is the moment the **second** chop is out of the oven. If one finishes first, pull it to the rack and let it wait.

If the two exits differ by more than about 6 minutes, sear sequentially, colder chop first. Under 6 minutes, sear together — but probe both and remove each individually at 145°F / 63°C rather than treating the pair as one unit. The post-sear rest is per chop, 7 minutes from its own removal; if they come out 90 seconds apart, the carve waits for the second.

Holding Chain

Component	Vessel & Condition	Planned Max Hold	Drift	Corrective
Crackling	Uncovered, dry spot, room temp	4 hr	Softens if covered	Never cover. 3 min at 400°F re-crisps
Cabbage	Covered pan, off heat	45 min	Tightens, dulls	1 tbsp water; reserved 15 ml vinegar at plating
Potatoes	Pan off heat, uncovered	12 min	Crust softens from residual steam	Do not cover. 60 sec over high heat before plating
Broccoli	Warm platter, uncovered	8 min	Char dulls, colour fades	None — plate within the window
Chops, pre-sear	Rack, uncovered, room temp	Fixed 8 min	Internal drops 2–3°F	None required — the window is fixed, not variable
Chops, post-sear	Warmed plate, uncovered, not tented	8 min	Tenting traps steam and degrades the crust	Never tent
Sauce	Pan, off heat	10 min	Mount breaks if reheated	Do not reheat. Whisk off-heat

Final Plating Window

Plates out at E+20. Cabbage first as the heat reservoir, then potatoes, then broccoli, then carved chop across. Crackling last. Sauce at the table. Two minutes between first plate and service. If the window is missed, the potato crust fails first.

Timeline — Absolute Phase

Time	Action
Saturday	Braise the red cabbage complete. Cool uncovered, refrigerate.
~2:00 pm	Collect. Confirm chop thickness at the counter — every timing number below is thickness-dependent. Ask whether the rind comes off as a sheet.
2:15 pm	Pat chops dry. 6 g / 2 tsp salt across both, all faces including fat cap and bone end. Uncovered on a rack, refrigerated. Brine window runs 3 hr 5 min.
2:20 pm	If rind available — Induction 1: rind in a cold heavy pan, low. Render 45–60 min, turning every 15 min, until fat runs clear and the sheet is amber and rigid. Medium-high 3–4 min to blister. Strain and reserve fat. Drain on a rack, salt 2 g while hot, hold uncovered.
4:45 pm	Potatoes into 1.25 L / 5 cups cold water with 12 g / 1 tbsp salt. Simmer 12–14 min to light knife resistance. Drain, steam-dry in the colander 10 min, crush to 1.5 cm. Hold uncovered at room temperature, or refrigerate if preferred — cold and dry crisps well.
5:15 pm	Oven to 225°F / 107°C. Confirm at temperature before loading.
5:20 pm	Chops on a rack over a tray, spaced, straight from the fridge. Leave-in probe into the thicker chop, clear of bone. Alarm 133°F / 56°C. Band 55–80 min.
5:30 pm	Induction 1 — sauce base: shallot 90 sec; 100 ml wine reduced near-dry 4 min; 150 ml stock plus 2 thyme sprigs, reduce 8–10 min to 70–80 ml. Off heat, hold.
6:15–6:40 pm	Chops exit on temperature, not clock. Thermapen the second chop before pulling. Each comes out on its own reading.

Timeline — Exit-Relative Phase

Start a timer when the second chop leaves the oven. E+0 is that instant.

Offset	Action
E-5	Probe reads 128°F / 53°C. Outdoor gas 1: fat, 3 smashed garlic, 3 thyme. Potatoes cut-face down. Crisp 24 min, turning at E+7.
E+0	Both chops out. Rack, uncovered. Rest 8 min. Oven to 170°F / 77°C, door cracked 2 min. Plates in.
E+2	Induction 2: cabbage covered, low. Reheat 15 min. Hold the reserved 15 ml vinegar — do not add yet.
E+8	Outdoor gas 3: cast iron high, neutral oil shimmering. Sear. 45–75 sec per broad face, colour-led. Fat caps on edge 45 sec. Butter, thyme, garlic; baste 30 sec. Probe both chops between faces and remove each individually at 145°F / 63°C.
E+10	Outdoor gas 2: broccoli in olive oil, high. Char 7 min, undisturbed the first 3.
E+12	Chops off as each reaches temperature. Warmed plate, uncovered, not tented. Rest 7 min from its own removal. Sear pan indoors to induction 1.
E+12	Sauce: pour off all but 1 tbsp fat. Pre-reduced base in, scrape fond 90 sec over medium-high. Off heat — both mustards, then cold butter cube by cube, then cider vinegar.
E+17	Cabbage off heat, stir in reserved 15 ml vinegar, cover. Broccoli off — lemon zest and juice of half through residual heat. Chilli flakes to a separate dish.
E+18	Taste the sauce and correct salt. First point the seasoning is real — the fond carries salt from the chops.
E+19	Potatoes off heat, uncovered, flaky salt. Carve chops off the bone, then across the grain into 1 cm slices. Rest slices 60 sec on the warm plate — note whether they hold or lose heat.
E+20	Plates out. Plate up — cabbage, potatoes, broccoli, chop. Crackling last.
E+22	Serve. Sauce at the table.

Meal Balance Audit

Richness: high — chop, fat-crisped potatoes, butter-mounted sauce, plus crackling if it happens. This is the plate's principal risk. The cabbage is the relieving component and must be portioned generously, not as a garnish. If crackling is on the plate, spoon the sauce sparingly rather than pouring.

Acid — three sources, distinct functions: red wine vinegar in the cabbage builds sweet-sour depth and fixes colour; white wine and cider vinegar in the sauce cut the butter mount; lemon on the broccoli is a fresh reset at the end of the plate. No duplication of function.

Sweetness: cabbage only, from apple and brown sugar. No stacking.

Texture: seared crust, crisp-shattered potato exterior against fluffy interior, charred broccoli stem, soft cabbage, brittle crackling if present. Contrast is carried across the plate rather than within every component.

Temperature: all hot. Plates are warmed — this addresses the negative-carryover finding from the salmon cook, where protein lost heat on room-temperature plates.

No dessert. The accumulated fat load does not support a continuation course. If one is wanted it should function as a reset — citrus granita or poached fruit, not a rich plate.

Shared Prep

Prepare these in aggregate before starting individual dishes.

Garlic: 5 cloves, all smashed skin-on — 2 → Chop baste · 3 → Potatoes

Thyme: 7 sprigs — 2 → Chop baste · 2 → Sauce · 3 → Potatoes

Butter: 60 g / 4¼ tbsp — 15 g → Chop baste · 20 g → Sauce mount (must be cold and cubed) · 25 g → Cabbage

Rendered pork fat from the crackling, if applicable: reserve all of it. 40 g goes to the potatoes; any surplus keeps refrigerated for weeks. If the yield falls under 40 g, top up with duck fat or olive oil — do not reduce the potato quantity to match.

Salt: Diamond Crystal kosher throughout. The 12 g for the potato water seasons the water, not the food.

Shopping List

Ingredient	Total	Pork + Sauce	Cabbage	Potatoes	Broccoli
PROTEIN					
Pork rack chops, bone-in, ~4 cm / 1.6 in	2 pc, 300–400 g / 11–14 oz each	2 pc	—	—	—
Pork rind sheet (conditional)	250 g+ / 9 oz+ if offered	—	—	—	—
PRODUCE					
Apple, Braeburn or Granny Smith	1 medium	—	1	—	—
Broccoli, tenderstem	250 g / 9 oz	—	—	—	250 g
Garlic	5 cloves	2	—	3	—
Lemon	1	—	—	—	1
Potatoes, waxy (Charlotte or red-skinned)	500 g / 1 lb 2 oz	—	—	500 g	—
Red cabbage	400 g / 14 oz	—	400 g	—	—
Shallot	1 medium, 40 g	1	—	—	—
Thyme, fresh	7 sprigs	4	—	3	—
PANTRY / DRY					
Bay leaf (pantry check)	1	—	1	—	—
Chilli flakes (pantry check)	¼ tsp	—	—	—	¼ tsp
Dijon mustard (pantry check)	1 tsp	1 tsp	—	—	—
Juniper berries (pantry check)	6	—	6	—	—
Soft brown sugar (pantry check)	20 g / 1½ tbsp	—	20 g	—	—
Wholegrain mustard (pantry check)	2 tsp	2 tsp	—	—	—
FRIDGE / DAIRY					
Unsalted butter	60 g / 4¼ tbsp	35 g	25 g	—	—
OILS & LIQUIDS					
Chicken stock	150 ml / ⅔ cup	150 ml	—	—	—
Cider vinegar (pantry check)	1 tsp / 5 ml	1 tsp	—	—	—
Duck fat or olive oil (only if no crackling)	40 g / 3 tbsp	—	—	40 g	—
Neutral oil (pantry check)	15 ml / 1 tbsp	15 ml	—	—	—
Olive oil (pantry check)	20 ml / 1½ tbsp	—	—	—	20 ml
Red wine vinegar (pantry check)	45 ml / 3 tbsp	—	45 ml	—	—
White wine, dry	100 ml / scant ½ cup	100 ml	—	—	—
SEASONING					
Black pepper (pantry check)	to taste	yes	—	—	—
Flaky salt (pantry check)	to finish	yes	—	yes	—
Kosher salt, Diamond Crystal (pantry check)	23 g (25 g with crackling)	6 g	3 g	12 g (water)	2 g

Sourcing Notes

Ask for the outcome, not the label. "Two bone-in chops off the loin rack, about 4 cm thick, 300–400 g each." Do not say double-cut — it means different things in different shops and forcing the term risks getting something else. Confirm the thickness before leaving.

Ask separately whether the rind comes off as a sheet. Do not buy one if it does not, and do not ask them to preserve it for this menu.

Buy the cabbage Saturday if possible — it is made the day before regardless.

1. Reverse-Seared Bone-In Rack Chops

Serves 3 · Total: ~4 hr 45 min · Active: ~12 min · Oven: 225°F / 107°C

Two thick bone-in loin chops, same-day dry-brined, taken slowly to temperature and finished with a short colour-led sear — firm and juicy at 145°F / 63°C with a dark, dry crust.

Ingredient	Amount
Pork rack chops, bone-in, ~4 cm / 1.6 in	2 pc, 300–400 g / 11–14 oz ea
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	6 g / 2 tsp
Black pepper, coarse	to taste, at the sear
Neutral oil	15 ml / 1 tbsp
Unsalted butter	15 g / 1 tbsp
Thyme	2 sprigs
Garlic, smashed, skin on	2 cloves

Salting Strategy

Same-day dry brine, roughly 3 hours, uncovered on a rack in the fridge. Overnight is the better option, but a Sunday afternoon collection makes it unavailable — the constraint drives the decision.

Three hours still does real work. Salt dissolves and begins moving into the muscle, and the uncovered fridge rest dries the surface, which is what lets a short sear build colour instead of steam. What you do not get is full equilibration, so the seasoning will read slightly more surface-weighted than an overnight brine would.

6 g is the chosen dose for this geometry — roughly 0.8% of gross weight for two chops at 600–800 g. Salting and air-drying are distinct operations sharing one window here: the salt seasons, the uncovered rest conditions the surface. Neither substitutes for the other.

Prep Phase

1. Pat every face dry with paper towel.
2. Salt all faces including the fat cap and the exposed bone end.
3. Rack in the fridge, uncovered, until the oven. Do not cover; do not rinse before cooking.

Active Cooking

1. Oven at 225°F / 107°C, confirmed at temperature and held constant throughout. Chops on a rack over a tray, spaced so air moves between them.
2. Leave-in probe into the thicker chop at its thickest point, angled clear of the bone — bone conducts differently and a bone-adjacent reading runs hot, which would pull you early.
3. **Pull each chop at 133°F / 56°C on its own reading.** The leave-in tells you about one chop only; Thermapen the second before pulling it. If they diverge, pull separately and rest the first on the rack.
4. Rest uncovered on a rack, 8 minutes.
5. Cast iron over high outdoor gas, neutral oil to shimmering. Both chops in. 45–75 seconds per broad face, with colour dictating the exact duration — dry-brined pork browns faster than expected and a fixed 90 seconds risks overshooting the crust. Fat caps on edge together, 45 seconds. Butter, thyme and garlic; baste 30 seconds.
6. **The sear is gated on temperature, not time. Probe both chops between faces and remove each individually the moment it reads 145°F / 63°C.** The second continues alone. If exits from the oven differed by more than about 6 minutes, sear sequentially, colder chop first.

Pull Temperature, Mechanism and Carryover

Oven exit 133°F / 56°C. The rise across the sear is active heating, not carryover — the two must not be conflated. No expected rise is given here deliberately: once 145°F is the decision trigger, a predicted figure becomes a competing metric that invites the cook to follow the wrong number. Passive carryover across the post-sear rest is expected to add 2–3°F onto warmed plates. Measure it. The salmon cook showed negative carryover onto room-temperature plates; a 350 g bone-in chop has far more mass, but the direction is a prediction, not a value.

Secondary Doneness Cue

Press the centre. Slow rebound holding a slight depression means at target; immediate tight spring-back means past. Corroborative only — the probe is the decision trigger.

Food Safety

The USDA standard for whole cuts of pork is 145°F / 63°C reached before removal from the final heat source, followed by a rest of at least 3 minutes. The sear is the final heat source, so the standard is met at the end of the

sear, and the 7-minute rest exceeds the required 3. Culinary target and safety requirement coincide at this endpoint — no trade-off is being made and none is claimed.

Holding & Assembly

Post-sear rest 7 minutes per chop, from its own removal, on a warmed plate, uncovered. Do not tent — tenting traps steam against the crust and degrades it. Carve off each bone in one piece, then across the grain into 1 cm slices. Fan onto warmed plates.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Internal overshoots past 68°C / 155°F — chalky, dry, fibrous. Loin has the least margin of any chop cut	Thermopen between sear faces. This is the gate, not the oven alarm	Unrecoverable. The sauce masks nothing
Major	Crust burns during the sear — acrid surface	Colour at 45 sec. Already dark mahogany means the pan is too hot	Lift and reduce heat. Recoverable at 45 sec; unrecoverable past 75 sec for that face, dish remains serviceable
Major	Pan crowded at the sear — surface temperature collapses, chops steam, no crust forms	No audible sizzle within 3 sec of contact	Remove one chop, sear sequentially. Unrecoverable for the first chop's timing; dish remains serviceable
Major	Sear ends before 145°F is reached — below the USDA endpoint	Thermopen reading on the chop being removed	Return to the pan on lower heat 30–45 sec. Fully recoverable — this is why the sear is temperature-gated
Minor	Fat cap unrendered — waxy band at the edge	Cap should be coloured and slumped, not pale and firm	Return the cap edge to the pan 30 sec

Adjust: taste a slice before saucing. If it reads flat, flaky salt on the cut surface — not stirred into the sauce, where it disappears. If it reads dry, log the observation with the actual pull temperature, sear duration, final reading, probe placement and brine window; do not assign a cause from one bite. Dryness here could originate in any of those, and a guessed attribution in the Vault is worse than none.

2. Mustard-Thyme Sauce

~150 ml, serves 3 · Active: 6 min live, 12 min prep · Hold: 10 min

A short butter-mounted sauce, base reduced in advance and finished on the fresh sear fond — sharp and glossy, deliberately not cider- or apple-based since the cabbage owns that axis.

Ingredient	Amount
Shallot, finely diced	1 medium, 40 g
Dry white wine	100 ml / scant ½ cup
Chicken stock	150 ml / ⅔ cup
Thyme	2 sprigs
Wholegrain mustard	2 tsp
Dijon mustard	1 tsp
Cider vinegar	1 tsp / 5 ml
Unsalted butter, cold, cubed	20 g / 1½ tbsp

Prep Phase

Why the base is pre-reduced: reducing 250 ml to sauce consistency takes 12–14 minutes, not the 5 a post-sear rest allows. Splitting it removes the dependency and costs nothing. The 225°F low-roast phase produces no usable fond — the chops sit on a rack and the tray stays dry — so this sauce is built on the sear pan alone, structurally independent of the low roast.

1. 5:30 pm: 1 tbsp fat in a saucepan, medium-low. Shallot 90 seconds, translucent not coloured.
2. Wine in, reduce 4 minutes to near-dry.
3. Stock and thyme in, reduce 8–10 minutes to 70–80 ml. Off heat, hold.

Active Cooking

1. E+12: pour off all but 1 tbsp fat from the sear pan. Induction, medium-high.
2. Pre-reduced base in, scrape the fond 90 seconds.
3. Off heat. Whisk in both mustards, then the cold butter cube by cube, each only when the last has emulsified. Cider vinegar last.
4. **Taste and correct salt at E+18**, after the fond and mustards are in. This is the first point the seasoning is real — the fond carries salt from the chops and the sauce is frequently seasoned enough already.

Holding & Assembly

Off heat in the pan, up to 10 minutes. Do not reheat — the mount breaks over direct heat. If it slackens, whisk off-heat.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Emulsion breaks — greasy and separated	Visible oil pooling at the surface	Off heat, whisk in 1 tsp cold stock. If still broken, unrecoverable for the sauce; serve the chops unsauced
Minor	Base over-reduced during the hold — sticky and gluey	Coats the spoon like gravy at E+12	Loosen with 1 tbsp stock before the fond step

Adjust: sharp reads call for one more butter cube. Flat and heavy calls for a few more drops of cider vinegar, not salt. If crackling is on the plate, spoon sparingly rather than pouring.

3. Braised Red Cabbage with Apple and Juniper

Serves 3 generously with leftovers · Total: ~1 hr 15 min · Active: ~15 min · Made Saturday

Sweet-sour, deeply coloured and fully yielding — the acid counterweight to a rich plate. Meal-level texture exemption: braised cabbage is inherently single-texture; contrast is provided by the potatoes, broccoli and chop crust.

Ingredient	Amount
Red cabbage, cored and finely shredded	400 g / 14 oz
Apple (Braeburn or Granny Smith), peeled, cored, coarsely grated	1 medium
Unsalted butter	25 g / 1¾ tbsp
Red wine vinegar — staged: 30 ml at the start, 15 ml reserved	45 ml / 3 tbsp
Soft brown sugar	20 g / 1½ tbsp
Bay leaf	1
Juniper berries, lightly crushed	6
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	3 g / ¾ tsp
Water	60 ml / ¼ cup

Prep Phase

1. Core and finely shred the cabbage.
2. Peel, core and coarsely grate the apple. Unpeeled turns leathery over a long braise and reads as stray skin in the finished dish.
3. Lightly crush the juniper berries.

Active Cooking

Use the narrow Le Creuset. The wide pot spreads the cabbage thin and the liquid evaporates before it softens, leaving it sharp and crunchy — the same geometry failure that thinned the milk braise.

1. Butter over medium-low. Cabbage, apple, 30 ml vinegar, sugar, bay, juniper, salt and water. Stir to coat.
2. Cover and cook 50–60 minutes over low, stirring every 15 minutes, until fully yielding and the liquid has nearly gone.
3. If liquid remains at 60 minutes, uncover and reduce 5 minutes. Cool uncovered, then refrigerate.

Holding & Assembly

Reheat covered over low induction, 15 minutes from E+2. Off heat at E+17, stir in the reserved 15 ml vinegar, cover and hold up to 45 minutes. Remove the bay leaf and any juniper you can find before serving.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Cabbage still firm when the liquid has gone — sharp, crunchy, unbalanced	Audible crunch; pan dry	Add 60 ml water, cover, 15 minutes more. Fully recoverable
Minor	Colour dulls to brown-purple — muddy appearance	Visual, against the raw cabbage colour	Insufficient opening acid. 1 tsp vinegar partially returns it

Adjust: taste after the reserved vinegar goes in. Flat calls for more vinegar in 5 ml steps; sharp calls for a pinch of brown sugar stirred through the residual heat.

4. Crushed Potatoes

Serves 3 · Total: ~40 min across two stages · Active: ~10 min

Par-boiled, crushed and crisped until the exposed edges shatter against a fluffy interior — the plate's carbohydrate anchor.

Ingredient	Amount
Waxy potatoes (Charlotte or red-skinned), unpeeled — the skin holds each potato together through the crush and crisps in the fat	500 g / 1 lb 2 oz
Water for boiling	1.25 L / 5 cups
Diamond Crystal kosher salt, for the water	12 g / 1 tbsp
Rendered pork fat if the rind was available, otherwise duck fat or olive oil	40 g / 3 tbsp
Garlic, smashed, skin on	3 cloves
Thyme	3 sprigs
Flaky salt	to finish

Prep Phase

1. 4:45 pm: potatoes into 1.25 L cold salted water. Bring to a simmer, 12–14 minutes to light knife resistance.
2. Drain. Steam-dry in the colander 10 minutes — surface moisture prevents crisping and this step is not optional.
3. Crush each to about 1.5 cm with the base of a glass, keeping it in one piece. Hold uncovered at room temperature, or refrigerate — cold and dry crisps well.

Active Cooking

1. E–5, when the chop probe reads 128°F / 53°C: fat, garlic and thyme in a wide pan over outdoor gas, medium-high.
2. Potatoes crushed-face down in a single layer. Crisp 24 minutes, turning once at E+7. Do not move them between turns — contact time is what builds the crust.

Holding & Assembly

Off heat at E+19, uncovered, in the pan. Maximum 12 minutes. Covering traps steam and the crust goes. If they slacken before plating, 60 seconds over high heat.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	No crust after 24 minutes — pale, slick, soft	Surface stays pale and greasy	Under-dried or crowded pan. Raise the heat and give them 6 minutes more in two batches
Major	Potatoes crumble apart at the crush — rough fragments rather than rounds	They fall apart instead of flattening	Under-boiled or a floury variety. Fragments still crisp. Unrecoverable as neat rounds; dish remains serviceable
Minor	Garlic burns — acrid smell, black slices	Visible blackening	Remove the garlic and thyme at the turn

Adjust: flaky salt at plating only. Applied earlier it dissolves and loses the textural contrast that is the reason for using it.

5. Charred Tenderstem Broccoli with Lemon

Serves 3 · Total: 8 min · Active: 8 min

Hard char on the stems with lemon off the heat — the plate's fresh reset against a heavy protein and fat-crisped potatoes.

Ingredient	Amount
Tenderstem broccoli, trimmed	250 g / 9 oz
Olive oil	20 ml / 1½ tbsp
Lemon — zest of the whole, juice of half	1
Chilli flakes, served separately	¼ tsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	2 g / ½ tsp

No garlic here, deliberately. Garlic already appears in the chop baste and the potatoes in the same smashed-and-infused role. A third instance would be ingredient redundancy without functional distinction, and this is the one component that should read clean.

Prep Phase

1. Trim the woody stem ends.
2. Zest the lemon and halve it.

Active Cooking

1. E+10: olive oil in a pan over high outdoor gas. Broccoli in a single layer, salted.
2. Leave undisturbed 3 minutes to build char on the contact face, then toss and cook a further 4 minutes.
3. Off heat at E+17. Lemon zest and the juice of half a lemon through the residual heat. Chilli flakes into a small dish at the table — this externalises the heat so Lukas takes his without.

Holding & Assembly

Warm platter, uncovered, 8 minutes maximum. The char dulls and the green fades past that window. Plate within it.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Stems raw when the florets have blackened — inedible tips, crunchy stems	Floret tips carbonised while the stem resists a knife	Pan too hot. Lower heat and cover 2 minutes to steam through. Unrecoverable for the florets; dish remains serviceable
Minor	Overcooked to army green — limp and dull	Colour shifts from bright to olive	Serve as is. Unrecoverable but cosmetic

Adjust: flat calls for more lemon juice, not salt. The chops and potatoes already carry the plate's salt load.

6. Crackling Shards — Conditional

Garnish for 3, plus ~40–55 g rendered fat · Total: ~1 hr · Active: ~10 min

Only if the rind came off the rack as a usable sheet. If not, this component does not exist and the potatoes take duck fat or olive oil.

Rind rendered slowly then blistered and broken into shards — the plate's brittle texture, and the source of the potato fat. Meal-level carve-out: crackling functions as the brittle texture element; no internal texture contrast required.

Ingredient	Amount
Pork rind sheet, scored	250 g+ / 9 oz+
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	2 g / ½ tsp

Prep Phase

1. Pat thoroughly dry on collection. A damp rind bubbles and goes leathery rather than blistering. There is no overnight fridge-dry available on this schedule, so dry it by hand.

Active Cooking

1. Rind into a cold heavy pan, fat side down, induction on low. Starting cold lets the fat render gradually instead of the surface seizing.
2. Render 45–60 minutes, turning every 15 minutes, until the fat runs clear and the sheet is amber and rigid.
3. Raise to medium-high, 3–4 minutes, until it blisters and puffs.
4. Strain and reserve all the fat. Drain on a rack and salt immediately while hot.

Holding & Assembly

Rack or bowl, uncovered, room temperature, up to 4 hours. Covering traps steam and it softens. Break into shards at plating. If it has softened, 3 minutes in a 400°F oven restores it.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Leathery rather than brittle — chewy and unpleasant	Does not shatter under knife pressure after blistering	Insufficient rendering. Low heat 15 minutes more, then re-blister. Recoverable
Major	Fat yield under 40 g — potatoes short of fat	Measure the strained fat before the potatoes go on	Top up with duck fat or olive oil. Do not reduce the potato quantity to match
Minor	Scorched at the blister stage — bitter	Dark brown patches spreading	Remove the scorched sections; the rest is fine

Adjust: salt while hot only. Applied cold it sits on the surface and tastes raw.

Designed, Not Validated — Post-Cook Confirmation Candidates

These parameters were engineered for this cook and have not been observed. Record each against actual and log to the Vault.

#	Parameter
1	Low-roast band 55–80 min at 225°F to 133°F from fridge-cold, two ~350 g bone-in 4 cm chops. The service window depends on it.
2	Actual sear gain from 133°F. Removed from execution and now pure measurement. Record the post-rest temperature entering the pan, the reading at the stop, and the total contact time — three numbers that together settle the pull point for every future pork reverse sear.
3	Carryover direction and magnitude across the 7-minute post-sear rest onto warmed plates. Record plate temperature alongside.
4	8-minute pre-sear rest — whether it dries the surface enough for a short colour-led sear.
5	Same-day 3-hour dry brine at approximately 0.8% gross — whether the seasoning reads surface-weighted.
6	Chop divergence at exit, and whether the 6-minute sequential-sear threshold was needed.
7	The exit-anchored convergence architecture itself — whether keying the last 22 minutes to the oven exit rather than the clock executes cleanly under live conditions.
8	Rind fat yield, if applicable. 40 g assumed.

Items 2, 3 and 7 carry beyond this cook. The rest are recipe-specific.